

Vladimir Kostelei

Senior Platform Engineer

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PROFILE

Senior Platform Engineer with 5+ years of experience building cloud infrastructure and developer platforms at Yandex Cloud / Smart Business Technologies, and 17+ years overall in software engineering. Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA).

Strong hands-on experience with Kubernetes, Terraform, Helm, Docker, CI/CD, Linux, Go, and Python. Experienced in leading technical initiatives across multiple engineering teams: Kubernetes migrations, deployment pipelines, logging and monitoring platforms, and infrastructure security improvements.

Looking for Senior Platform Engineer, SRE, DevOps, or Cloud Infrastructure Engineer roles. Open to relocation (visa sponsorship required) or fully remote work.

CORE SKILLS

Platform Engineering	Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD
Cloud & Infrastructure	AWS, GCP, Digital Ocean, Hetzner, Linux, Nginx, PaaS
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, Fluent Bit
Security	WAF, Distrosless images
CI/CD & Tooling	TeamCity, GitHub Actions, Ansible, Vagrant, Packer
Programming	Go, Python, Bash, TypeScript, Dart/Flutter

EXPERIENCE

Smart Business Technologies / Yandex Cloud

2022 – 2026 · Serbia

Senior Platform Engineer / Technical Lead

- Led the migration of Cloud Console and UI services from VM-based Instance Groups to Kubernetes, improving deployment consistency and infrastructure maintainability.
- Launched UI infrastructure for new cloud regions in Israel and Kazakhstan.
- Launched and technically led two new cloud products from inception: Cloud Center, a cloud-native operations platform, and Security Deck, a CNAPP product.
- Owned common Docker images for UI services and led the adoption of Distrosless images, reducing image size by ~70% and significantly reducing critical CVEs.
- Owned security improvements across UI services, including Web Application Firewall (WAF) integration and security-focused platform features.
- Built and operated an observability stack for Cloud UI services, including a Fluent Bit logging pipeline handling ~12 MB/s and Prometheus/Grafana alerting.
- Coordinated platform and infrastructure work across a team of up to 14 engineers while remaining hands-on in architecture, delivery, and operations.

Yandex Cloud

2020 – 2022 · Russia

Senior Platform Engineer / Technical Lead

- Designed, built, and maintained deployment pipelines using TeamCity, Terraform, and Helm.
- Led the migration of Yandex Cloud from cloud.yandex.ru to yandex.cloud.
- Led the migration of 30+ repositories from GitHub to an internal Yandex source code platform.
- Managed on-call rotation and led incident response, post-incident reviews, postmortems, and root cause analysis for production services.
- Supported production infrastructure reliability for cloud console and related user-facing cloud services.

Yandex News

2018 – 2020 · Russia

Senior Frontend Engineer / Technical Lead

- Led frontend development for Yandex News.
- Owned frontend development for the launch of Yandex Sport, which reached 1.5M daily active users.
- Designed and built a shared React/TypeScript frontend framework and led migration of services to it.
- Improved performance metrics and reduced VM count from 2,500 to 1,000 through frontend architecture and infrastructure changes.
- Led design and implementation of Protobuf support in the shared Yandex frontend library.

Mann, Ivanov and Ferber

2015 – 2018 · Russia

Frontend Developer

- Developed the company website and e-commerce platform using AngularJS.
- Built an internal URL shortener service using PHP and AngularJS.
- Worked on production web applications, frontend architecture, and supporting backend services.

Early Career

2007 – 2015 · Russia

Web Developer / PHP Developer

- Built websites and web applications using Zend Framework, Bitrix, AngularJS, Node.js, and PHP.
- Developed SOAP services, infrastructure tooling, and full-text search integrations using Sphinx.
- Worked with Linux systems, SVN, iptables, and production web infrastructure.

CERTIFICATIONS

- [Certified Kubernetes Administrator \(CKA\)](#)
- Diving into Python — MIPT / VK / Coursera
- C++ Fundamentals: White Belt & Yellow Belt — MIPT / Yandex / Coursera

EDUCATION

Altai State Technical University — Computer Science

2005 – 2010

AWARDS & PROJECTS

- Prize winner: Tinkoff (T-Bank) CTF and Yandex CTF; running a CTF team; TryHackMe and Hack The Box.
- [Coding Overhead](#): technical blog and Telegram channel.
- Personal automation projects: Telegram bots and channels using Python and Node.js.
- [V&G Blue](#) (Hugo theme); [Screenshotgun](#) (C++ screenshot utility).

LANGUAGES

Russian — Native · English — Professional working proficiency · Serbian — Elementary